

AdvisoryAI Hack-to-Hire: Challenge Briefs

The Context: Life as a UK Financial Advisor

Before diving into the challenges, understand who you're building for.

A typical UK Independent Financial Advisor (IFA) manages 150-250 client relationships. They work within strict regulatory frameworks set by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA), including Consumer Duty regulations introduced in 2023 that require demonstrating ongoing value to clients.

Their day is overwhelmingly reactive: responding to client emails, fielding calls, chasing paperwork, and drowning in administrative tasks. The irony? They became advisors to *advise* people—yet most spend 60-70% of their time on admin, not advice.

A Note on Scope & Mock Data

This is a one-week hackathon. We're not expecting you to build integrations with CRM systems, portfolio platforms, or provider APIs—that's months of work.

Instead, work with mock data that represents realistic advisor scenarios. We'll evaluate your approach to the problem, your architecture, and your thinking—not whether you've connected to Intelliflo.

Create sample client profiles, example meeting notes, realistic document request scenarios. The mock data should feel authentic to the problems described below.

Challenge 03: Agentic Chaser

The Problem Space

The LOA Nightmare

Before an advisor can give advice on a client's existing pensions, investments, or policies, they need information from the current providers. To get that information, they need a signed Letter of Authority (LOA).

This is the single biggest time-sink in UK financial advice.

The typical process looks like this:

The advisor identifies that a client has pensions with three different providers. Each provider requires its own LOA. The advisor sends the LOAs to the client for signature. The client takes a week or two to sign and return them—sometimes signing incorrectly, sometimes missing pages.

Once signed, the advisor sends each LOA to the relevant provider. Provider processing times vary from 10 to 20+ working days. Information often comes back incomplete, requiring follow-up. Sometimes providers claim they never received the LOA. Sometimes they need additional verification.

Meanwhile, the client is waiting. And asking for updates. And the advisor has nothing to tell them.

The phone queue reality:

When advisors need to chase providers or get urgent information, they call. And they wait.

"Your call is important to us. You are number 47 in the queue."

Average hold times run 30-45 minutes. Advisors often get transferred and have to explain everything again. They're frequently told information will be posted in "10-15 working days"—by post, not email.

One advisor described spending two hours on hold with a single provider, just to confirm a transfer value. Two hours. For one piece of information. For one client. And they have 200 clients.

Scale of the problem:

A single pension consolidation case can require 10-15 LOAs across multiple providers. The process typically takes 3-6 months from start to finish. During that time, the advisor is juggling dozens of other cases, each with their own LOAs in various stages of the process.

Tracking what's been sent, what's been received, what needs chasing, what's stuck—this is a constant cognitive burden.

The Client Document Chase

Before giving advice, advisors need information from the client themselves. This is called the "fact-find."

Commonly needed documents include:

- Proof of identity (passport, driving licence)
- Proof of address (utility bill, bank statement)
- Existing pension statements

- Investment valuations
- Protection policy documents
- Payslips for pension contribution calculations
- P60s for tax planning

The chase cycle:

The advisor requests documents. The client sends some but not all. The advisor requests the missing ones. The client sends the wrong version. The advisor clarifies what's needed. The client goes quiet for a week. The advisor chases again.

This isn't client negligence—people are busy, documents are confusing, instructions get lost in email threads. But the result is the same: weeks of back-and-forth for every engagement.

Post-Advice Chasing

Once advice is given, there's more to chase:

- Signed application forms
- Completed risk questionnaires
- Authority to proceed confirmations
- Anti-money laundering verification documents
- Responses to annual review letters

Each item has its own chase cycle. Each delay extends the case timeline.

The State Tracking Problem

At any given moment, an advisor might have:

- 15 LOAs sent to providers at various stages
- 8 clients with outstanding document requests
- 12 application forms awaiting signature
- 20 annual reviews pending client response

Tracking all of this manually—knowing what to chase, when to escalate, what's actually stuck versus what's just slow—is exhausting. Things fall through cracks. Clients get frustrated. Cases drag on for months.

Context for Your Build

The chasing problem is fundamentally about communication, state management, and knowing when to act.

Consider the communication channels advisors actually use: email, phone, SMS, occasionally WhatsApp. Consider what information they need to track: what was sent, to whom, when, what response came back, what's still outstanding.

Your mock data should represent realistic chasing scenarios: clients at various stages of document submission, providers with different response times, cases with multiple outstanding items.

Think about what "autonomous" actually means in this context. What can genuinely be automated versus what needs human judgment? Where are the boundaries?

Final Thought

The best financial advisors build deep relationships and give transformative advice. Everything else is friction.

Your challenge: understand the friction deeply, then show us your approach to eliminating it.

Good luck builders.